LUTHERAN INDIAN MINISTRIES

REPORT TO THE BOARD OF DIRECTORS · NOVEMBER 3–4, 2026

The Website's First Two Months

Covers 3 August (launch) – 8 October 2026 · prepared by Gary Ricke, Orbis Design

The new site went live on 3 August. Its job is not traffic for its own sake: it is to turn interest into people in the room — registrations, applications and requests. This report counts what it produced, shows what visitors read, and is plain about what we can and can't yet measure.

19	16	1,032	2 min
HEALING-GROUP REGISTRATIONS	TREE OF LIFE APPLICATIONS	VISITS FROM THE ANCHORAGE AD	AVERAGE TIME ON SITE, U.S. VISITORS

1 · WHAT THE SITE PRODUCED

Every item below is a form someone filled in on the site, so these are complete counts — not samples or estimates. Duplicate submissions by the same person are counted once.

ACTION	WHEN	COUNT
Online Healing Group registrations	Aug 4–7, for the Aug 5–14 group	8
Anchorage Healing Group registrations	Aug 23 – Oct 9, for Oct 9–10	7
Facilitator Equipping Training sign-ups	Aug 4 – Oct 7	4
Tree of Life Gathering applications	Aug 17 – Sep 18, for Sep 21–23	16
Bible-in-a-Year study Bible requests	Aug 26 – Oct 5	3
Email newsletter sign-ups	Since launch	1

Before launch, Tree of Life applications went through a paid Jotform account and healing-group sign-ups came by phone and email. All of it now lands on LIM's own site, in one place, at no per-form cost.

ONLINE GIFTS

Gifts go through the Blackbaud donation form on the site's Give page. Angie pulled these from Blackbaud by calendar month:

MONTH	GIFTS	DOLLARS
August	46	$9,591
September	31	$6,037
October (to the 12th)	9	$1,210
Total	86	$16,838

> **WHAT WE CAN'T YET SAY ABOUT GIFTS**
>
> We can't yet tell which gifts came from an ad, an email or someone giving on their own. Feathr's donation tracking credited no gifts to its ads (Section 3), and LIM's emails don't yet tag their donate links. Both are on the fix list in Section 5.

2 · WHAT VISITORS READ, AND WHERE THEY CAME FROM

> **READ THESE NUMBERS AS PROPORTIONS, NOT TOTALS**
>
> Google Analytics only counts visitors who click *Accept* on the site's cookie notice — a privacy protection we chose deliberately. Our own ad data shows how big the gap is: in the first four days of the Anchorage ad, Facebook delivered 773 visits but only 83 were counted. The counted sample is 449 people, 698 visits and 1,008 page views, and nearly a third of those "people" are overseas bots that stay one second. The patterns below come from the real visitors. Section 4 explains how we'll get a full count.

PAGE	SHARE OF PAGE VIEWS
Home	61%
Healing Groups	18%
About	9%
“The Choice: Native OR Christian?” (story)	6%
Give / Donate	5%

- **Healing Groups is still the second-most-visited page,** exactly as it was on the old site. It is what people come for.
- **Google search brings the most engaged visitors** — two-thirds of them read on, for close to two minutes. About one visit in five comes from Google.
- **Visitors from our Facebook ads were the most engaged of all** (78% read past the first page). Paid ads are the newest channel and already the best-quality one.
- **Most U.S. visitors stay about two minutes**, which on a ministry site means reading, not bouncing.

3 · ADVERTISING

CAMPAIGN	SPENT	RESULT
Zion “Songs & Stories of Hope” concert, Fairbanks	$249.57	Seen by 4,821 people in the Fairbanks area, about 5 times each
Anchorage Healing Group, Oct 9–10	$250	1,032 visits to the healing-groups page at about 16¢ each (to 7 Oct); 6 of the 7 Anchorage registrations arrived after the ad started
Fairbanks Healing Group, Nov 11–13	$250	Scheduled to run 28 Oct – 11 Nov

Feathr display and retargeting ads, run by Meyer Partners, ran 15 August – 30 September and are not running now. Figures are from Meyer’s report:

FEATHR, AUG 15 – SEP 30	RESULT
Spent	$1,486.40
Times the ads were shown	780,807
Clicks to the site	6,303 (0.81%)
Cost per click	$0.24
Gifts credited to the ads	0

- **Delivery was steady and cheap until late September.** Then from 24–29 September clicks almost stopped: $193 bought 59 clicks. Meyer is looking into why.
- **The first ten days (5–14 August) are left out.** The ads weren't yet limited to the U.S. and Canada, and most clicks in that period came from overseas.
- **"0 gifts" means the ads' effect on giving wasn't measured, not that it was zero.** Feathr can only credit a gift if the giver accepted the site's cookie notice, and most visitors never do. The tracking also has not yet been checked end-to-end with a real gift.

4 · CONVERSION RATE — WHAT WE CAN HONESTLY SAY

A true conversion rate is actions divided by all visitors, and we don't yet have the "all visitors" number (see Section 2). The clearest measured case is Anchorage: about 1,000 ad visits produced 6 registrations in the same window, **a little under 1%**. For a two-day trauma-healing group, a much bigger ask than a click, that is a reasonable start, and it is the first real benchmark LIM has.

5 · WHAT WE'RE FIXING BEFORE THE NEXT REPORT

- **Make ad-driven gifts measurable.** Confirm Feathr's donation tracking with a real test gift, have it count only completed gifts, and tag the donate links in LIM's emails. Then the next report can say which channel each gift came from.
- **Count every visit, without cookies.** Add a privacy-friendly, server-side visit counter so the board sees full totals, alongside Google Analytics for behaviour. Small monthly cost (about $9).
- **Track the newer pages.** Camp Perkins, the event recaps, the event flyers and the Tree of Life pages were built after launch and aren't yet counted at all.

- **Report registrations as a goal in Google Analytics,** so “did it work” is answered automatically each month.
- **Restore Google Search Console access,** which shows how often LIM appears in Google searches and for what.
- **Connect newsletter sign-ups to MailChimp** and make the sign-up more visible — one sign-up in two months says it’s too easy to miss.

Sources: Netlify form records (complete); Google Analytics 4 property G-ZLC3QT9T1E, consenting visitors only; Meta Ads Manager; Blackbaud online gifts (Angie Pantazon, 12 Oct); Feathr campaign report (Meyer Partners, 13 Oct). Window 3 Aug – 8 Oct 2026 unless noted. Prepared 9 October, updated 14 October 2026.